

Understanding BIS Hallmarking, HUID and Fineness · Consumer Guide (Sample)

WHAT IS HALLMARKING

Hallmarking is the accurate determination and official recording of the proportionate content of precious metal in jewellery and artefacts. In India the Bureau of Indian Standards operates the hallmarking scheme: jewellery conforming to the relevant Indian Standard is assayed by a BIS-recognised Assaying and Hallmarking Centre and marked with the BIS hallmark.

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WHAT IS HUID

HUID stands for Hallmark Unique Identification. It is a six-character alphanumeric code laser-marked on each hallmarked jewellery item. Every hallmarked piece gets a unique HUID, which allows the consumer to trace that specific item: who the jeweller is, which Assaying and Hallmarking Centre hallmarked it, the fineness and when it was hallmarked. HUID-based hallmarking has been in force since July 2021.

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PARTS OF THE BIS HALLMARK

A complete BIS hallmark on gold jewellery contains five marks: 1. The BIS mark (triangle). 2. The purity or fineness grade, for example 916 for 22 karat, 750 for 18 karat, 585 for 14 karat and 999 for 24 karat gold. 3. The mark of the BIS-recognised Assaying and Hallmarking Centre. 4. The identification mark of the jeweller. 5. The six-character HUID code. If any of these is missing, ask the jeweller for an explanation before buying.

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HOW TO VERIFY HALLMARK INFORMATION

Consumers can verify a HUID using the official BIS Care mobile application or the BIS website. Enter the six-character HUID to see the registered details of the item. The BIS hallmarking scheme applies to registered jewellers selling gold jewellery; hallmarking of gold jewellery in mandatory scope has been implemented in phases from June 2021. Silver hallmarking is voluntary. Always verify the current scope and rules on the official BIS source.

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IMPORTANT LIMITATIONS

The presence of a hallmark indicates that the item was assayed at the time of hallmarking. A hallmark is a mark of conformity, not a guarantee of a specific item's current condition. BIS Buddy cannot judge whether any particular jewellery item is genuine; it can only explain which markings exist and how to verify them through official channels. For a definitive assessment, consult a BIS-recognised Assaying and Hallmarking Centre.